אתרים

המגזין

מועצה לשימור
אתרי מורשת בישראל

כסלו תשע"ח, דצמבר 2017
www.shimur.org.il

07

ספריית יהודה דקל
מועצה לשימור אתרי מורשת בישראל

משרד
התרבות
והספורט

The Role of Art, Tradition, and Beliefs in Defining Cultural Landscapes

Until 1992, the members of the World Heritage Organization sufficed with the definition of a "mixed heritage site," when including places that represent natural and cultural heritages in their list. In 1992, the World Heritage Committee added the definition of "cultural landscapes" to its list and defined three categories for classifying them, thus elevating the status of the mixed sites. Nevertheless, their number in the list of World Heritage Sites is not great, and in 2017, only 35 sites – out of a total 1073 – were so designated. The explanation for this small number lies in the difficulty of managing a mixed site, due to its size and the difference between the conservation approaches applied to landscapes and cultural assets. Conservators of the former advocate minimal human intervention, while the latter encourage it, in order to maintain, stabilize, and – if necessary – reconstruct the object of conservation. In the case of acknowledging an associative cultural landscape, these difficulties are compounded by the issue of defining the significance of the landscape. As a rule, the significance of an associative cultural landscape arises from the strong religious, artistic, or cultural context of nature, and not necessarily from the material cultural evidence, which may be secondary or even nonexistent. Indeed, there are almost no sites of this type in the World Heritage list.

The Christianization of a Landscape: Associative Cultural Landscapes in the Northern Sea of Galilee

Yael Alef

The landscapes of the northern Sea of Galilee are associated with the gospels and the pilgrimages to holy sites since the infancy of Christianity and to this day. The landscape is intertwined with the stories and the stories are intertwined with the landscape, shaping and changing each other, generation after generation. These are the "associative cultural landscapes" of a living religious heritage. The landscape is part of the dynamic social and cultural processes that create the collective Christian memory, and at the same time, they are a product of these processes. Work on preparing the nomination proposal for inclusion of Christian sites in UNESCO's World Heritage in 2007-2009 gave rise to questions about their cultural significance and ways of examining them, and the need to revisit the conservation of this heritage. The article analyzes the relationship between the landscape, the gospels, and the pilgrimage traditions as the basis for its evaluation and conservation.

Keywords: associative cultural landscape, conservation, living religious heritage, cultural meaning, the northern Sea of Galilee, collective memory, Christianity, Crusader movement, sacred places

Figure 1. Landscapes of the northern Sea of Galilee conserve the places where pilgrims walked for hundreds of years on a spiritual journey in search of the gospel. Photo: Itamar Greenberg, 2008

This is an adaptation of my article, "Going for Cultural Landscapes of the Northern Sea of Galilee," which was based on material included in the nomination proposal of the Christian sites in the Galilee for UNESCO's World Heritage list, and especially the chapters that deal with the cultural landscapes of the northern Sea of Galilee, which was written with the assistance of Prof. Irit Amit, Aviad Sar Shalom, Yossi Stepansky, and Dr. Yaakov Ashkenazy (http://www.iaa-conservation.org.il/article_item_heb.asp?id=99&subject_id=39).

Introduction

The view from the Mount of Beatitudes reveals the landscape of the Sea of Galilee, which is surrounded by steep, rocky slopes of the Golan mountains in the East and the Arbel cliffs in the West. At the foot of the hill, the barren basalt Korazim hills slope downwards, leaving a narrow, grassy strip along the lakefront. This shore is checkered with the ruins of fishing villages and harbors from the Roman era, the remains of Byzantine churches, modern churches and prayer sites, and a well-developed system of services for pilgrims, who have visited the Christian holy sites, including Tabgha, Capernaum, and Kursi, for generations.

The landscapes of the northern Sea of Galilee reflect one the formative dramas of history of the West, telling the story of Jesus and his disciples and the development of the Christian moral teachings. The landscapes mentioned in the four gospels that describe the life, death, and resurrection of Jesus organize the spatial frame of the story (Zoran, 1997). The connection between the space in the text and the physical space associated with the Christian beliefs and traditions that developed in the northern Sea of Galilee create an associative cultural landscape,[1] and this dynamic serves as the foundation of the cultural significance of the sites (see Figures 1 and 2).

Recognition of the cultural value of these landscapes led to their inclusion in Israel's tentative list for the UNESCO World Heritage sites and preparation of a proposal for nomination of the Christian sites in the Galilee in 2007-2009 (Alef & Cohen, 2009). The process of submitting a nomination highlights the difficulties in conservation and management of the holy sites in the northern Sea of Galilee.[2] The ICOMOS evaluators who came to assess the proposal noted the challenge of resolving the conflict between the accepted approach to conservation of traditional cultural landscapes and the modern development of the northern Sea of Galilee, which has included the construction of hotels, walkways, and parking areas to accommodate the dozens of buses of pilgrims. Hundreds of thousands of pilgrims come to the area to walk in the footsteps of Jesus and get a first-hand look at the places described in the gospel, but their very presence and the development to accommodate their needs create a new, different landscape. The attempt to resolve the conflict requires a different way of understanding the meaning and the conservation of associative landscapes associated with a living religious heritage.

Figure 2. A modern sitting area for pilgrims in the shade of a Christ's thorn, on the slopes of the Mount of Beatitudes. Photo: Itamar Greenberg, 2008

[1] For a definition of associative cultural landscape, see UNESCO (2017), p. 81, The Operative Guidelines for Implementation of the World Heritage Convention (1972) http://whc.unesco.org/en/guidelines/

[2] The process of submitting nominations was not completed and the sites have not yet been declared as world heritage, mainly because of the difficulty of presenting a comprehensive management system for the serial nomination of sites with different stakeholders, and because of the issue of the authenticity of the places.

Although religious heritage is one of the most popular categories of world heritage sites, paradoxically there are almost no doctrinal texts on the subject. Moreover, in many countries, religious heritage sites are not protected by the legislation on heritage. Perhaps this is due to reluctance about addressing such a sensitive subject, and an assumption that conservation of these places is the responsibility of the religious institutions. The ICCROM Forum on Living Religious Heritage emphasized that the main objective of heritage conservation is to ensure its continuity by means of constant processes of renewal, which revive the cultural and symbolic significance of the places (Stovel, Stanley Price, & Killick, 2005). The concern for sacred places and their adaptation to changes in the form of ritual give them value and constitute a layer in the development of associative cultural landscape. The living aspects of religious heritage shift the focus of conservation from the material to the human activity and to the intangible values of the heritage.

The View from the Mount of Beatitudes

The Christian traditions identify Mount Naum, located north of the Kinrot Valley, as the place where the Sermon on the Mount was delivered: "Now when Jesus saw the crowds, he went up on a mountainside and sat down. His disciples came to him, and he began to teach them. He said: Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted. Blessed are the meek, for they will inherit the earth" (Matthew 5: 1-5, NIV). We find evidence of this tradition in the late fourth century, when the pilgrim Egeria reported, "Near there on a mountain is the cave [above Job's Spring – Y.A.], to which the Savior climbed and spoke the 'Beatitudes'" (Wilkinson, 1971, p. 196) (see Figure 3). Further evidence are the ruins of a Byzantine chapel built to commemorate the sermon, which was discovered in 1935 at the foot of the mountain, near Tabgha (see Figure 4). The choice of this location in the Byzantine period was based on the desire to concentrate the holy sites for the convenience of visitors. In 1938, an octagonal chapel, designed by the architect Antonio Barluzzi, was built on the mountaintop. It has horizontal windows that emphasize the view and strengthen the universal moral message of the Sermon on the Mount. Barkay and Shiller (1999) argued that moving to the mountaintop indicates the elevation of the status of the sermon in Christianity since the eighteenth century, and the strengthening of the universal narratives of the teachings of compassion. The spatial interpretation of the Mount of Beatitudes is an example of the complex relationship and the interaction between the tangible landscape and intangible traditions.

There is evidence of human activity in the northern Sea of Galilee area as early as prehistoric times. Due to the comfortable natural conditions, abundance of water, and location on the route of migration from Africa to Asia, humans settled at the Ubeidiya site more than a million years ago. On the shores of the Sea of Galilee, dozens of other prehistoric sites have been discovered, including one of the most ancient fishing villages in the world, at Ohalo II (Nadel, 1993). The influence of humans on the landscape increased in the Neolithic period (8000-4000 BCE), when they moved to permanent settlements and began developing an agrarian economy, cultivating fields, and herding domesticated animals.

Throughout history, the Sea of Galilee basin served as an important crossroads of one of the branches of the Via Maris, which led from Egypt to Damascus and Palmyra. In the Bronze and Iron Ages, prospering cities developed at the stream deltas, where the narrow strip of beach widens a bit. Important tels of these cities remain were discovered at Tel Beit Yerah, Tel Ein Gev, Tel Hadar, Tel Bethsaida, Tel Kinnarot, and Tel Rakat (Stepansky & Zingboym, 2011).

At its peak, in the Roman and the Byzantine period, the Sea of Galilee was surrounded by a tight ring of villages and towns: Bethsaida, Kursi, Susita, Bet Yerah, Hamat Tiberias, Tiberias, Magdala, Ginosar, Hukok, Kur, Korazim, and Capernaum. The residents engaged in fishing, and every settlement has an anchorage or a harbor (Nun, 2011). The landscape in this period was characterized by irrigated agriculture in the fertile valleys, non-irrigated agriculture, and pasture areas, alongside the remains of the ancient cultures, such as the tels and the concentration of dolmens and tumuli in the Korazim area – evidence of a landscape that has changed very little in the past 4000 years (Stepansky, 2005). These are, in fact, cultural landscapes that formed over thousands of years of human activity in the area.

In addition to these processes, the influence of the churches and the pilgrims in the Byzantine period also left its mark on the landscape. In the thirteenth century, the region was no longer on the pilgrimage route; its rediscovery began only in the late nineteenth century,

Figure 3. The cave mentioned in Egeria's account as the place where Jesus delivered the Sermon on the Mount. Photo: Itamar Greenberg, 2008

Figure 4. Remains of a small chapel and monastery from the Byzantine period on the Mount of Beatitudes, near a cave associated with the ancient tradition of the Sermon on the Mount. Photo: Itamar Greenberg, 2008

and more so in the 1930s, when development of the sites began (Goren, 1999). This activity continues today; it includes the construction of churches, monasteries, and services for pilgrims. At present, there are several operating churches in the area: the Benedictine church at Tabgha; the Franciscan churches at Magdala; the Church of the Primacy and Capernaum; the Franciscan sisters at the Mount of Beatitudes, and the Greek Orthodox church at Capernaum. A large project of the New Gate to Peace Foundation is now underway at Magdala, including an archeological park, a church, and a hotel.

The Fifth Gospel: Landscapes of the Holy Land

"Jesus went throughout Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, proclaiming the good news of the kingdom, and healing every disease and sickness among the people" (Matthew 4: 23, NIV).

The landscapes of the Galilee, and particularly of the northern Sea of Galilee, are woven into the four gospels of Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John. The time of writing of the gospels is generally placed in the late first and early second century CE. Although the gospels were not written as historic texts, and the role of the landscape mentioned in them is mainly allegorical and theological, the descriptions of Jesus wandering between Nazareth and Capernaum, in Korazim and Bethsaida, in the mountains and along the shores of the Sea of Galilee reflect the character of the Galilee at that time.

"Five gospels record the life of Jesus. Four you will find in books and one you will find in the land they call holy. Read the fifth gospel and the world of the four will open to you" (Pixner, 1992, cover). This is how the priest and researcher Bargil Pixner described the relationship between the landscape that developed organically as a result of social, technological, economic, and political processes that took place in the northern Sea of Galilee area and the associative landscape associated with the place in the gospels. He claimed that reading the physical landscape enables a better understanding of the gospels; "the Holy Land" is the land of the "Holy Scriptures," and the landscape takes on deep significance by means of the way it is referred to in the New Testament.

This approach was accepted as early as the fourth century. For example, the Onomasticon (On the Place-Names in the Holy Scripture), by Eusebius of Caesarea, was based on historical sources and the sites themselves, which were used to identify the places mentioned in the Old Testament and the New Testament with existing places.

A similar viewpoint has motivated many researchers since the nineteenth century to tour the country, using the New and Old Testaments as guides. Gustaf Dalman, director of the German Protestant Institute of Archaeology in Jerusalem, based the theology studies there on study of the Holy Land and established a new research division in the field of Palästinawissenschaft (Palestine Studies). This field combined research in

geography, botany, and ethnography of the country with Hebrew and Greek studies, based on the view that it was important to understand the Old Testament and the New Testament in the context in which they written (Serr, 2016) (See Figure 5).

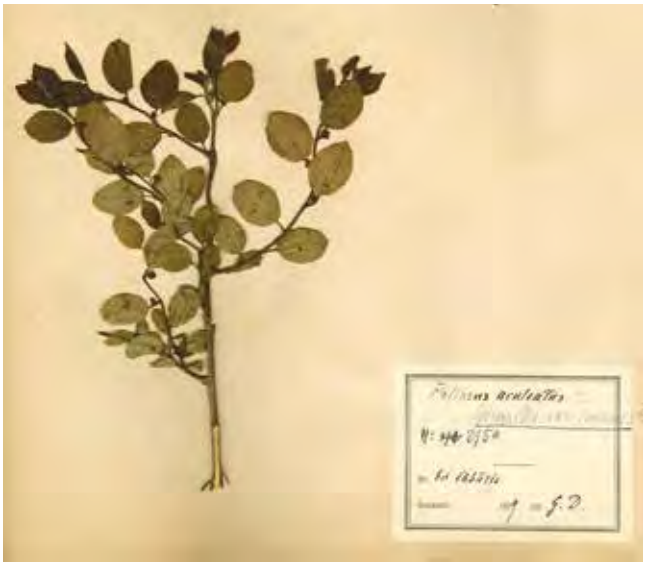

Figure 5. An example of a dried branch of the Zizyphus Spina Christi tree from 1909, which Gustaf Dalman collected during his research of local flora. Zizyphus Spina Christi is common in the semi-arid climate of the Korazim plateau, particularly on the slopes leading down to the Sea of Galilee. The name, which means Christ's Thorn in Latin, refers to the crown of thorns in the story of the Crucifixion. Gustaf-Dalman collection, inventory number: GDIh0290. Copyright: Gustaf-Dalman-Institute Greifswald.

The Role of Sacred Geography in Creating the Collective Memory

In The Legendary Topography of the Gospels in the Holy Land, Halbwachs (1992) analyzed the role of "the place" in the development of the collective Christian memory in the gospels and in the creation of the holy places. Halbwachs tried to understand the rules that guided the Christian community in sanctifying the places, and how it addressed the absence of physical evidence of the activity of Jesus and the apostles in the first century CE, and the fact that the gospels were written decades after the events they described occurred.

Halbwachs examined two possible scenarios of the process of shaping the sacred geography. The first attributes a grain of historical truth to the gospel, that Jesus lived and was active in the Galilee and in Jerusalem. Testimonies of the faithful of events and places in the life of Jesus were preserved in the local memory and integrated later into the gospels. However, Halbwachs preferred another scenario, according to which the gospels that developed near the end of the first century CE are a collection of ideas that were made into stories by a group of faithful who knew the places; they put the sermons, the parables, and the miracles into Jesus' mouth and placed them in villages and other sites along the shores of the Sea of Galilee. According to Halbwachs, in order to anchor the abstract ideas of Christianity, such as justice, grace, and compassion in the collective memory, it was necessary to embody them in people, events, and places, and to organize them into a story. The places mentioned in the gospels give the story credence, thus strengthening the faith. In an analysis of the term "place" in the context of the Land of Israel and the Bible stories, Gurevich (2007) expressed a similar idea, writing about the place that is concrete and, at the same time, symbolic and conceptual, a place that is a reality of a story, more than a story of reality. He notes that the story preceded the reality and in a way, demands it.

It seems that the basic mapping and primary organization of the local Christian memories (especially in the Jerusalem area) was related to the places that are familiar in Jewish traditions, and therefore it was preserved in the first centuries of the Common Era, when Christianity was still a persecuted religion. In the fourth century CE, with the transformation of Christianity into the official religion of the Roman Empire, a retrospective process of identifying the places began. Rituals associated with these places began to develop, and they became places that connected groups of believers. The faithful made them into holy places, preserving the collective memory while also creating it. In the next stage, churches and chapels were built in order to meet the expectations of the pilgrims. This process set the abstract ideas in the physical landscape and made the imaginary collective memory into a real place (see Figure 6).

By nature, the Christian collective memory preserves events and places that represent the dogma of the church and have pedagogical significance, and not necessarily the reality of the gospels. For this reason, even though descriptions of Jesus in the Galilee occupy a significant part of the gospel, the construction of churches and holy sites in the Byzantine period focused on Jerusalem, which was where the events of the passion of Jesus took place during the last week of his life.

In the fourth and fifth centuries AD, the mapping

Figure 6. Christian pilgrims holding mass on the waterfront in Tabgha, on a spiritual journey to discover the gospel in the landscape of the Holy Land. Photo: Itamar Greenberg, 2008

of the sacred geography developed, but in the wake of the destruction caused by the Muslim conquest, some of the places were forgotten, providing an opportunity for Crusaders to redraw the map according to the Christian beliefs that developed in Europe. One example is the identification of Via Dolorosa in Jerusalem, which did not exist before that. Thus, in time the sacred geography was shaped not necessarily on the basis of topographical reality, but mainly according to changes in religious views and considerations of convenience, intended to make the travels of the pilgrims more comfortable. This was a critical factor in terms of the Church, because of the economic importance of the pilgrimages (Tzaferis, 1999). A similar process of developing new sites continues to this day. An example is the Yardenit baptismal site, where water flows from the Sea of Galilee into the Jordan River. It was built in 1981 as a substitute for the traditional baptismal site at Qasr el-Yahud, because of the difficulty of access to the border area of Jericho.

The Landscape in the Story

According to Halbwachs, the landscape plays a central role in the texts. The landscapes of the Galilee are reflected in the gospels in two ways: in places where events in the life of Jesus took place, and in parables and images of the local flora and fauna. Both ways demonstrate the local farming and fishing life and the character of the region. Thus, for instance, in the springtime, when the slopes of the hills are colored with carpets of yellow mustard flower, we find the parable of the mustard seed:

> *What shall we say the kingdom of God is like, or what parable shall we use to describe it? It is like a mustard seed, which is the smallest of all seeds on earth. Yet when planted, it grows and becomes the largest of all garden plants, with such big branches that the birds can perch in its shade (Mark 4: 30-32, NIV)*

Figure 7. installation carved into rock at Huqoq Ruins ("Huqoq installation"), which may have been used to make mustard oil, as mentioned in the Talmud. Photo: Yael Alef, 2016

Another mention of the mustard plant can be found in the Talmud, regarding the mustard industry in Huqoq (Jerusalem Talmud, Shevi'it, 9, 25, 71). The commentary tells the story of R. Shimon Ben Lakish, who was in Huqoq, saw them gathering mustard, and a seed fell to the ground. The gatherer did not pick it up.[3] In the survey of Khirbat Huqoq, dozens of unique installations were found carved into the rock, which may have been used to make mustard oil (Tepper, Dar'in, & Tepper, 2000) (see Figure 7).

Another example in the gospels is the suggestion of the western winds blowing at the Sea of Galilee towards evening, which are surprisingly strong (Nun, 2011). The strong winds prevented Jesus's disciples from sailing to Bethsaida, as described in the miracle of walking on the water: "Later that night, the boat was in the middle of the lake, and he was alone on land. He saw the disciples straining at the oars, because the wind was against them. Shortly before dawn he went out to them, walking on the lake" (Mark 6: 47-48, NIV).

The description of this characteristic condition of the lake supports the literary message. Another example is the concentration of basalt dolmen graves and tumuli in the area of Korazim. These may be the "tombs" described in the miracle of the pigs, in which Jesus restored the possessed man: "When Jesus got out of the boat, a man with an impure spirit came from the tombs to meet him. This man lived in the tombs" (Mark 5: 2-3, NIV) (Stepansky, NA).

These examples demonstrate expressions of the landscape in the gospels. However, where can we read the Christian narrative in the landscape itself?

[3] The commentary refers to the laws regulating the cultivation of the land during the year of shmita, when one is meant to let the land rest, and the question was whether the seed that fell, which had a good chance of growing, was subject to those regulations. Translation to Hebrew and commentary, Shahar Puni.

Figure 8. Stone altar and mosaic of the fish and a basket of loaves at the Church of the Multiplication of the Loaves and the Fishes in Tabgha. Photo: Yael Alef, 2007

The Story in the Landscape: Christian Traditions in the Landscapes of the Northern Sea of Galilee

A century of research and archeological excavations in the area have not provided findings related directly to Jesus and the apostles or to Christian activity in the area in the first century CE. However, the findings excavated at Capernaum, and particularly at Magdala and the many harbors dispersed along the shores of the lake, indicate the situation reflected in the gospel and the Christian traditions that developed from the fourth century on.

The landscapes of Tabgha valley are an example of the interpretation of the landscape in light of the Christian narrative. The tradition connects Tabgha with several important events: the call to the apostles, the miracle of the loaves and the fishes, the sermon on the mount, the appearance of Jesus to his apostles after his death, and the bestowal of primacy on his disciple, Simon (Peter). Excavations have uncovered remains of churches from the Byzantine period that commemorate these events, and sites that were forgotten have been re-identified with the Church of the Multiplication of the Loaves and Fishes (see Figure 8), the Church of the Primacy of Peter (see Figures 9, 10), the chapel on the slopes of the Mount of the Beatitudes (see Figure 3 above), in the church above the Peter's house in Capernaum and in Kursi.

The name Tabgha is a deformation of the Greek, heptapegon, meaning "the seven springs." This area of the Sea of Galilee is one of the most abundant fishing regions, due to the warm-water springs that attract the fish. A small harbor was discovered here, and this is the location identified with the tradition about Jesus, according which: "As Jesus walked beside the Sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and his brother Andrew casting a net into the lake, for they were fishermen. 'Come, follow me,' Jesus said, 'and I will send you out to fish

Figure 9. The Church of the Primacy of Peter (Mensa Christi) on the shore of the Sea of Galilee at Tabgha, against the background of the slopes of the Mount of Beatitudes. The church was built in 1934 on top of the ruins of the Byzantine church and ancient quarries. The tradition identifies the Church of the Primacy as the place where Jesus appeared before the apostles after his resurrection, performed the second miracle of the fishes, and dined with them on the rock in the center of the church, which commemorates the event, and then bestowed the primacy on Peter. Photo: Yael Alef, 2009

Figure 10. Painting by Konrad Witz (1444) depicting the second miracle of the fishes, which Jesus performed after his resurrection. At the forefront of the picture, we see Jesus in a red robe, with the apostles raising the basket full of fish, and Peter in the water. In the background, we see the landscape of tilled fields at Tabgha and the surrounding mountains. Source: Wikipedia.[4]

Figure 11. Tabgha valley, which is identified in the traditions with the miracle of the loaves and fishes

[4] A public domain work of art: https://commons.wikimedia.org/w/index. php?title=File:Konrad_Witz_-_Fischzug_Petri.jpeg&oldid=259094816

for people.'" (Mark 1: 16-17, NIV). The fertile valley with its many springs was part of the farming land of Capernaum (see Figure 11). The scene depicted, of an unsettled agricultural region, fits the descriptions in the story of the miracle of multiplication of the loves and the fishes (Matthew 14: 15-21, NIV).

Another source of information about the development of the holy sites are the descriptions of the journey of pilgrims who visited the Holy Land beginning in the fourth century. Already from the time of Egeria, the significance of the cultural landscapes at Tabgha was dynamically constructed from the living traditions that shaped the landscape throughout the periods. In her account of the pilgrimage of 381-384 CE, Egeria described Tabgha:

> *And in the same place by the sea is a grassy field with plenty of hay and many palm trees. By them, are seven springs each flowing strongly. And this is the field where the Lord fed the people with the five loaves and two fishes. In fact the stone on which the Lord placed the bread has now been made into an altar. People who go there take away small pieces of the stone to bring them prosperity and they are very effective. Past the walls of this church goes the public highway on which the Apostle Matthew had his place of custom… .* (Wilkinson, 1971, p. 196)

The altar and the Roman road she mentioned were uncovered in archeological excavations that began at the site in 1898. During the dig, remains of a small fourth-century church commemorating the miracle of the loaves and the fishes was found, and above it, remains of an ornate basilica from the fifth and sixth century CE, adorned with the famous mosaic of a basket of loaves of bread and fish (see Figure 8 above). Since its discovery, this mosaic has become one of the most common symbols of the Holy Land in the Christian world. In 1980, a modern church was constructed on the location of the ancient basilica, using the stone of the altar and the ancient mosaic floors.

Conclusion

The key to the conservation of associative cultural landscapes in the northern Sea of Galilee area lies in understanding the significance of the holy sites and the connection between the physical landscape, the gospels, and the traditions that have developed in the area since the beginning of Christianity. How did the physical landscape affect the development of the gospels? Which landscapes are described in the gospels themselves? How did the gospels influence the development of the landscape, and how did the landscape, in turn, influence the interpretation of the gospel in each period of time?

The narrative and the landscape construct one another and change according to the periods. The abstract ideas of the faith are supported by concrete events and tangible places that organize the story. For example, the location of the "beatitudes sermon" on the Mount of Beatitudes gives the story credence and strengthens its messages in the collective memory. The landscapes of the northern Sea of Galilee area, with its chapels, churches, and sitting areas for holding masses on the shore play a part in the dynamic social and cultural processes of creating the collective memory, and at the same time, are the product of those processes.

With the writing of the gospels there also began the writing of a dynamic and living story of the traditions of pilgrimages to holy site. For more than 1600 years, the story has been constructed, layer upon layer, and embedded in the landscape, with the footsteps of tens of thousands of pilgrims coming to the shores of the Sea of Galilee, praying there, and creating the collective Christian memory. In the landscapes of the sacred geography lie the remains of the "sacred history," and powerful connections are created: of the tangible local landscape with the spiritual; of the worldly with the holy; of the past with the future. The dialogue is ongoing; it takes place between the landscapes in the texts and the stories of the landscape, and is rewritten in every generation.

* Yael Alef, Architectural Conservator Israel Antiquities Authority and Department of Environment and Geography, Bar Ilan University

Yael Alef is an architectural conservator at the Israel Antiquities Authority. She specializes in surveying, documentation, and planning historical buildings and towns and archeological sites. Alef holds a master's degree in conservation of monuments and sites from the Catholic University in Leuven, Belgium, and is a doctoral candidate at Bar-Ilan University. In 2006-2007, she coordinated the preparation of the nomination proposal for inclusion of the Christian sites in the Galilee in the UNESCO World Heritage List.

Alef, Y., and Cohen, M. (2009). *Sites of Christianity in the Galilee: Proposed World Heritage Serial Nomination*. Israel Antiquities Authority report.
Barkay, G., and Shiller, E. (1999). The Mount of Beatitudes. *Ariel: The Kinneret and Its Environs in the Christian Tradition, 139*, 62-67. (Hebrew)
Gurevich, Z. (2007). *On Israeli and Jewish place*. Tel Aviv: Am Oved Publishers Ltd. (Hebrew)
Goren, H. (1999). The Christian activity on the shores of the Kinneret in the modern times. *Ariel: The Kinneret and Its Environs in the Christian Tradition, 139*, 125-132. (Hebrew)
Halbwachs, M. (1992). The legendary topography of the Gospels in the Holy Land. In M. Halbwachs (ed.), *On collective memory* (trans. L. Coser) (pp. 193-236). Chicago, IL: University of Chicago Press.
Nadel, D. (1993). Submerged archaeological sites on the shores of lake Kinneret. *Atiqot, 22*, 1-22. Retrieved from http://www.jstor.org/stable/23457069
Nun, M. (2011). *Sea of Kinneret: A monograph*. Jerusalem: Ariel – Kibbutz Ein Gev. (Hebrew)
Pixner, B. (1992). *With Jesus through Galilee According to the Fifth Gospel*. Rosh Pina, Israel: Corazin.
Serr, M. (2016). Understanding the land of the Bible: Gustaf Dalman and the emergence of the German exploration of Palestine. *Near Eastern Archaeology, 79*(1), 27-35.
Stepansky, Y. (2005). The Megalithic culture of the Corazim Plateau, Eastern Galilee, Israel: New evidence for a chronological and social framework. *Mediterranean Archaeology and Archaeomtry, 1*(5), 39-50.
Stepansky, Y. (NA). *The antiquity site of "Shegerat-el-Mubarakat" (Horvat Berech) (Domus Galilaeae, Korazim Plateau)*. (Retrieved 20 November 2017) http://www.stepansky.co.il/about-4.html
Stepansky, Y., and Zingboym, O. (2011). The Kinneret Trail, Survey, *Hadashot Arkheologiyot – Excavations and Surveys in Israel, 123*. (Retrieved 20 November 2017) http://www.hadashot-esi.org.il/Report_Detail_Eng.aspx?id=1766&mag_id=118
Stovel, H., Stanley Price, N. P., & Killick, R. G. (2005). *Conservation of living religious heritage*. Papers from the ICCROM 2003 Forum on Living Religious Heritage, Conserving the Sacred. Rome: ICCROM.
Tepper, Y., Dar'in, G., and Tepper, Y. (2000). *Nahal Amud area*. Ra'anana: Hakibbutz Hameuchad. (Hebrew).
The Holy Bible, New International Version (NIV). (Retrieved 23 November 2017) https://www.bible.com/bible/111/MRK.1.16-18.niv
Tzaferis, V. (1999). The history of the Christian holy places in the Land of Israel. *Ariel: The Kinneret and its Environs in the Christian Tradition, 139*, 24-14. (Hebrew)
UNESCO. (2017). *The Operative Guidelines for Implementation of the World Heritage Convention*. (Retrieved 20 November 2017) http://whc.unesco.org/en/guidelines
Wilkinson, J. (1971). *Egeria's travels*. London, UK: S.P.C.K.
Zoran, G. (1997). *Text, World, Space*. Tel Aviv, Israel: Tel Aviv University – Hakibbutz Hameuchad. (Hebrew)

P.162: Tabgha valley, which is identified in the traditions with the miracle of the loaves and fishes

שיקולי העדפה ובִּטּוּיִם בתהליך קבלת החלטות בדבר שימור המורשת התרבותית המוחשית

ההחלטה לשמר נכסי מורשת תרבותית מתאפיינת בשיקולי העדפה. לשיקולים אלה היבטים שונים, ובתהליך קבלת ההחלטות, מה לשמר, לשם מה לשמר, מי ישמר, איך לשמר ולאיזו מטרה, הם באים לידי ביטוי בצורות שונות. **באתרים - המגזין 8** יוצגו הצדדים השונים של שיקולים אלה.

ניצנים הישנה, ניצן החדשה, בית ספר שדה שקמים ופארק החולות - לאלה שני פנים, האחד, הם מייצגים מרחב שימור מרובה נופים ונכסים הנושאים ערכים היסטוריים, חברתיים, תרבותיים וסביבתיים. השני, הם מבטאים דילמות הכרוכות בבחירה מה לשמר וכיצד.

יהודה דקל, יליד 1929, בן לראשוני הרצליה, איש פלמ"ח מהגדוד השלישי בחטיבת יפתח, חבר הכשרת הצופים דפנה וממקימי קיבוץ יראון בגליל. לחם במלחמות ישראל וסיים שירותו במילואים כסגן אלוף, מג"ד שריון במלחמת יום הכיפורים.

בוגר מקוה ישראל ומוסמך למדעי החקלאות של האוניברסיטה העברית. איש המחלקה להתיישבות של הסוכנות היהודית במשך שנים רבות. מבוני חבל לכיש, ממתכנני הנגב, ממפתחי חבל ירושלים, גוש עציון והבקעה, הוביל את פיתוח התעשייה והתיירות בהתיישבות, יזם הקמת מערכת מחקר ופיתוח חקלאיים ושימש כמנכ"ל המחלקה להתיישבות בשנים 1981-1989 שבהן ניצח על מפעל ההתיישבות הכפרית בארץ.

כיהן כיו"ר הוועד המנהל של מועצה לשימור אתרי מורשת בישראל. מחבר הספר "מצודת כ"ח - רעות תחת אש", המתעד את קרבות נבי יושע במלחמת העצמאות, מקום בו נפלו רבים מרעיו. **מייסד "מוזיאון הרעות" וממדליקי המשואות של יום העצמאות** תשס"ו-2006 לכבוד מפתחי הנגב והגליל.

יהודה דקל נפטר בינואר 2008 לאחר התמודדות אמיצה במחלה קשה. מועצה לשימור אתרי מורשת בישראל ומשפחת דקל חברו יחד והקימו מפעל להצנחת שמו ומורשתו - **"ספריית יהודה דקל"**. "מגזין אתרים" מהווה חוליה נוספת בשרשרת הפרסומים של הספרייה לזכרו של יהודה דקל.

ISSN 2519-6057